have to remember the age in which it was written, the environment and mental climate in which it grew, the vast distance in time and thought and experience that separates it from us. We have to forget the trappings of ritual and religious usage in which it is wrapped, and remember the social background in which it expanded. M a n y of the problems of human life have a permanence and a touch of eternity about them, and hence the abiding interest in these ancient books. But they dealt with other problems also, limited to their particular age, which have no living interest for us now.

T h e V e d a s

M a n y Hindus look upon the Vedas as revealed scripture. This seen;; to me to be peculiarly unfortunate, for thus we miss their real significance — the unfolding of the h u m a n mind in the earliest stages of thought. And what a wonderful mind it was! T h e Vedas (from the root *vid,* to know) were simply meant to be a collection of the existing knowledge of the day; they are a j u m b l e of m a n y things: hymns, prayers, ritual for sacrifice, magic, magnificent nature poetry. There is no idolatory in them;